

as well.” What this means is that AI isn’t reshaping software development on the fringe or in niche corners. It’s quietly becoming the foundational baseline.

India’s developer scale turning into global influence

“In this past year itself, there were more than 5 million developers who joined GitHub just from India,” Karan notes. If AI is redefining development everywhere, India is amplifying that change through sheer participation – and increasingly, contribution. That surge has placed India in rare territory.

“India is our single largest source of new developers on GitHub this year... and the second largest developer community that is present on GitHub itself.” But presence is only the opening act. What truly matters is what developers do once they arrive. “For the very first time ever, India has the highest number of open source contributors... overtaking the United States as well,” mentions Karan, with a wide smile.

That milestone is easy to gloss over, but it’s profound. Open source is where modern software standards are negotiated, tested, and normalized. Leading there means shaping how software is built globally. India’s influence extends directly into AI innovation too. “India is the second biggest source of contributions to AI-related repositories as well.”

For GitHub and Karan, this convergence of scale and contribution signals something a lot more structural. “AI is almost like the baseline expectation that developers have... and India has a very unique position where so many developers are able to contribute back to global projects,” he says.

The combination of AI lowering barriers and India’s massive developer base is creating a compounding effect – one that’s difficult to replicate elsewhere.

Open source, Indian languages, future trends

If AI is accelerating development, open source is out there multiplying its impact. One of the quiet revolutions AI

Don’t ignore Cursor, the master AI code writer

In the crowded world of AI coding assistants, Cursor isn’t just another autocomplete toy — it’s a full-blown AI-powered IDE built on VS Code that supercharges developers without slowing them down. Unlike basic suggestion engines, Cursor understands your entire codebase, predicts multi-line logic, and even lets you chat with your code in natural language to generate, refactor, debug, or explore functions without leaving your editor.

Cursor’s strength lies in its context awareness and deep project insight: it doesn’t just predict the next token — it anticipates your intent across files, helps you navigate unfamiliar codebases, and streamlines large-scale refactors. Its built-in AI chat and smart rewrite tools mean boilerplate disappears while clean, efficient logic takes its place.

For seasoned engineers, this translates to fewer interruptions, fewer bugs, and more focus on real problem-solving. Beginners benefit too: natural-language prompts turn vague ideas into working code, lowering the barrier to entry without dumbing down power.

In short, Cursor blends familiarity with next-gen AI smarts, making it the prime choice for developers who want AI that truly codes with them, not just for them.

enables is learning-by-doing at scale, Karan points out.

Previously, contributing to a complex open source project meant wrestling with documentation, setup scripts, and institutional knowledge. Today, developers can simply just ask. “Help me set this up locally. Explain how this actually works,” Karan says. The learning curve that once discouraged participation has flattened dramatically.

This matters enormously in a country like India, where developers span geographies, institutions, and languages. GitHub’s approach emphasizes choice – of models, workflows, and increasingly, language. “Copilot supports many Indian vernacular languages,” Karan notes. One student’s story stayed with him: the student had prompted Copilot in their native language, received responses in the same script, and suddenly the AI barrier wasn’t comprehension anymore, but simply imagination.

Looking ahead, GitHub projects that by 2030, one in three new developers globally will be from India. That scale will bring not just more code, but new problem spaces, cultural contexts, and priorities into global software.

Agentic AI will only amplify this, according to Karan. “Developers are able to delegate entire tasks to AI agents... and orchestrate a fleet of them.” The model is collaborative, not autonomous, he highlights. “Teams of developers working with a swarm of these AI agents, while a developer really orchestrates and ensures everything is going right,” suggests Karan, based on his expectations of how Agentic AI will increasingly manifest in software development going forward. 

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